
Lost & Found in Public Transport

Problem Space Report — Barcelona Focus with Global Comparative Context

Prepared May 2026 | GNN Challenge Research Brief

This report documents the current state of lost-and-found operations in Barcelona's public transport network, surveys international approaches, catalogues documented failures and successes, and compiles the quantitative evidence base for the problem space. **No solutions are proposed.**

1. Scale of the Problem: Global Overview

Macro-Level Statistics

- **400 million+ items** lost annually in the US alone (Lostings.com, 2023)
- **400,000+ items** lost in public transportation annually across major networks
- **82% of UK passengers** have left something behind on public transit; **over 60%** never got it back (NotLost survey, Sep 2020)
- **£2.2 billion (~€2.5B)** worth of possessions lost on UK public transport in 2021; **~1,500 phones/keys/cards/headphones lost every hour** (Direct Line Group, 2022)
- Average person spends **2.5 days/year** searching for lost items; average **5 days** for items to reach a lost-property service (Lostings.com, 2023)
- Cost to return one item to its owner: **~£100 (~€115)** accounting for labour, postage, and packaging — TfL benchmark (NotLost / The Guardian)
- Global lost-and-found software market: **\$91.72M in 2025** → projected **\$316M by 2035** at 13.17% CAGR (Business Research Insights, 2025)
- Public transport application segment: **\$0.2B (2023)** → projected **\$0.35B (2032)** (Market Research Future, 2025)

Behavioural Data (UK — NotLost Survey, Sep 2020)

- 82% of passengers have lost something on public transport
- Over 60% did not get their item back
- 90% of people who find items attempt to return them — willingness is not the bottleneck
- Items take an average of 5 days to reach lost-and-found services

Key Pain Points

- No centralised lost property management system across multi-operator networks
 - Systems used by different operators do not communicate with each other
 - Items can take 48 hours to 28 days to be located
 - Most depots require in-person collection — impossible for tourists, disabled passengers, or those who have left the city
 - Lost-and-found enquiries are historically the single biggest driver of customer service phone calls for operators using manual systems
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2. Barcelona: Current Situation

Network Scale (2023–2024)

- **TMB Metro:** 8 lines, 165 stations, 125.4 km, ~479.91M annual journeys
- **TMB Bus:** 104 lines, 2,635 stops, 820 km, ~223.19M annual journeys
- **Barcelona metro area total (2023):** Record **1,087M journeys**, +17% from 2022, exceeding 2019 pre-pandemic peak by 3% (ATM, Feb 2024)
- **Tourism:** ~26–32M visitors in 2023; 12M in formal accommodation; ranked 7th in Europe for overnight stays

The Fragmentation Problem: Four Separate Systems, Zero Integration

Barcelona has four completely separate lost-and-found systems with no shared database and no unified passenger-facing interface:

Operator	Scope	Lost Property Contact
TMB	Metro (8 lines) + City buses	Punt TMB Diagonal; phone 900 701 149; online form (frequently unavailable)
FGC	Commuter rail (Vallès + Llobregat-Anoia lines)	Customer centres at Plaça Catalunya and Plaça Espanya
Rodalies (Renfe)	Commuter rail (Sants + regional)	Office at Sants; FindMyLost for long-distance — NOT Rodalies
Ajuntament / Oficina de Troballes	Municipal aggregator — receives overflow from TMB after 10–21 days	Carrer de la Ciutat, 2; Mon–Fri 9am–2pm only

A passenger who cannot identify which operator's vehicle they were on must contact all four offices separately, across separate phone numbers, websites, and physical locations.

TMB Lost-and-Found: Process Flow

Found item → Vehicle driver/station staff → TMB Info Point at Sagrada Família (L5) [coded + entered into internal DB] → Punt TMB Diagonal (min. 48h wait) → [after 10 days] Vilapicina depot warehouse (1 additional month) → [after ~21 days] Documents/phones/cameras → Oficina de Troballes | Transit cards → Cetransa (destroyed) | Clothing → Conductors Solidaris de Catalunya (NGO)

Weekend gap: Bus depot closures on weekends create up to **4-day delays** before bus finds even enter the tracking system.

TMB Statistics

- **~22,000–27,000 items/year** (~11,000–12,500 metro; ~11,600–14,500 bus) — TMB Notícies; salirporbarcelona.com citing TMB 2022 data
- **2022:** ~5,760 items returned to owners (~2,160 metro; ~3,600 bus) → **~25% recovery rate**
- **2018:** 8,269 items returned → **~30% recovery rate**
- Items arrive at the collection point: **10–50 per day**
- Seasonal spikes: Summer (towels, sunglasses, umbrellas); September (backpacks, folders); rain (umbrellas, gloves)

Digital channels: Primary is a phone number (900 701 149). The online form at tmb.cat was non-functional as of research date. No mobile app integration. No photo upload. No real-time status tracking. No automated notifications.

Oficina de Troballes (Barcelona City Council)

- **Hours:** Mon–Fri, 9am–2pm only
- **Volume:** ~20,000 items/year historical average; **32,200 in 2022**; 27,240 in Jan–Oct 2023
- **Return rates:** 28.5% (2022); 29.6% (Jan–Oct 2023); ~35% (official quoted figure, 3CatInfo)

- ISO 9001 certified since 2009

Sources of items delivered to the Oficina de Troballes:

Source	Share
TMB (after 10–21 day holding window)	42%
Mossos d'Esquadra (Catalan police)	25%
Guàrdia Urbana (city police)	24%
Other (public, municipalities, consulates)	9%

Disposition of unclaimed items: 20% recycled; jewellery/cash to municipal treasury; official documents to issuing agencies; 1% to finders after 6 months.

The Stolen vs. Lost Ambiguity

Barcelona's severe pickpocketing problem blurs the lost-and-found signal — a passenger who cannot find their item cannot determine whether it was lost or stolen:

- Pickpocketing accounts for **~48–49% of all crimes** in Barcelona (2023, Ajuntament de Barcelona)
- Metro thefts were **up 47% YoY** in the first 9 months of 2023 (447 violent muggings in that period)
- **90% of stolen items are unrecovered**
- Xarxa initiative (2011) reduced pickpocket theft by **34% over 3 years** (26,130 → 17,156 reported robberies) by tracking ~100 repeat offenders — but the baseline problem remains large-scale

3. Comparative City Analysis

London — Transport for London (TfL)

- **Volume:** 200,000–438,000 items/year; currently 1,200+ items/day across 8 modes (Tube, bus, Overground, Elizabeth line, DLR, tram, river, 400+ stations)
- **Recovery rate:** Only **21.7% of items reclaimed** by owners — TfL itself called it 'a very small success rate' (Diana Quaye, LPO Performance Manager)
- **Item breakdown (2010/11):** Books 41,370 | Bags 31,005 | Clothing 28,672 | Valuables/wallets/laptops 25,665 | Phones 23,432 | Keys 10,632 | Glasses 10,150 | Umbrellas 8,052
- **Revenue from unclaimed items (FY2023/24):** £88,050 (claimed fees) + £283,948 (unclaimed cash) + £199,136 (sale of items)
- **Storage:** 3 months, then donated/auctioned/recycled; cash held 1 year
- **History:** Lost Property Office founded 30 October 1933 at Baker Street; moved to West Ham (October 2023) with 62,000 items in storage
- **Technology upgrade (March 2022):** TfL awarded NotLost (UK startup) the contract to replace its legacy system — the largest such contract in Europe. NotLost provides AI-assisted matching and operator workflow tools.

Why it failed before: Legacy manual system could not handle 400,000+ items/year. Matching was done manually — described by TfL as inefficient at scale. Only 21.7% reclaim rate despite 90 years of institutional experience.

New York City — MTA

- **Volume:** ~68,000 items/year; 31,500+ claims filed (2024 data)
- **Recovery rate (2013):** ~42% of handed-in items claimed — MTA executive Paul Fleuranges (FiveThirtyEight, 2014)

Inspector General Audit — Documented Systemic Failure:

- 24 test items turned in undercover on subway trains/buses
- Only **4 items (17%)** reached the Lost Property Unit
- Only **1 item** successfully returned to the 'owner'
- **Over 80% of items** turned in by transit workers were never logged in the database
- Average time from station booth to Lost Property Unit: **27.4 days**
- Items from dispatcher locations (cleaners): **55.2 days** average
- Root causes: 'poor documentation,' 'inefficient matching,' 'too laborious' claim process
- As of July 28, 2014: MTA held **168,478 items**; had reunited **55,921** with owners

NYC represents the worst-case scenario — chain-of-custody failure at every stage, not a technology failure per se but a process and accountability failure.

Tokyo — Metropolitan Police & Railway Operators

- **Volume (2023):** 4.4 million lost items received by Tokyo Metropolitan Police — up 19.9% from 2022; records set two consecutive years
- **Cash handed in (2023):** ¥4.4 billion (\$29M) — new record; ¥3.2B (73%) returned to owners; ¥500M to finders (Japan's Lost Property Act: finders entitled to 5–20% of value); ¥600M reverted to government
- **Item categories (2023):** ID/driver's licenses 812,625 (18.3%) | Transit cards 471,223 (10.6%) | Clothing 400,792 (9.0%) | Wallets 338,823 (7.6%) | Umbrellas 294,196 (6.6%) | Phones: 219,761 reported lost; 142,450 handed in; 120,222 returned
- **Return rates by type:** Phones ~83% | ID documents ~72% | Wallets ~68% | Overall average ~14% across all 4.4M items (low-value items like umbrellas mostly not claimed)
- **Infrastructure:** 825 police boxes (koban) serve as community hubs. Railway operators hold items 1–4 days before transferring to police. Police hold 3 months total.

AI Transformation — Find Inc. (launched June 2023):

- Founded December 2021; platform: '_find_'
- **Keio Corporation** (69 stations, ~500 lost-item inquiries/day) as proof-of-concept; trial Feb 2023, adopted May 2023
- Result: Return rate **nearly tripled** (from <10% → ~30%)
- Phone/counter inquiries **reduced by one-third**
- AI registers items from photos in **~1 minute** vs. ~10 minutes manually
- Multilingual: Japanese, English, Chinese, Korean (expanding to 100+ languages)
- Adopted by **33 companies** nationwide by early 2025; JR East adoption planned April 2026
- Platform totals: **1.5M items registered; ~480,000 returned**

Cultural Context (Science, 2019 — Cohn et al.):

A field experiment dropping 17,303 'lost wallets' in 355 cities across 40 countries found return rates ranging from 14% to 76% by country. Japan consistently among the highest. People were more likely to return wallets containing more money — contradicting economic self-interest predictions, attributed to altruism and aversion to being perceived as a thief.

Seoul — Seoul Metro / LOST112

- **Volume (2024):** 152,540 lost items (~418/day) — Seoul Metro Corporation
- **Historical recovery rate:** Up to **85%** for subway items
- **Cash return (2024):** 77.2% of cash found in Seoul subways returned to owners
- **Most common (2020–2024):** Wallets (23.9% over 5 years), mobile phones, clothing (23,435 items in 2024)

Key Technology — LOST112:

In October 2017, Seoul Metro fully integrated with the National Police Agency's LOST112 system. Once a station employee logs an item, it is immediately visible to every police precinct and citizen in the country. LOST112 is the **single national source-of-truth** for all lost property in South Korea — covering subway, buses, taxis, airports, and police simultaneously. This is the primary reason Seoul achieves ~85% recovery vs. Barcelona's ~25–30%.

Paris — RATP

- **Volume:** ~200,000–220,000 lost objects/year on metro, bus, tram (~1,300/day)
- **Key finding:** **84% of lost objects** are found by other passengers (not staff); **93% of those finders** want to return them — the bottleneck is the matching system, not finder willingness
- **Process:** Items held at station for 48h → transferred to Paris Police Prefecture Lost Property Service
- **Platform:** FranceObjetsTraouvés — national digital system shared across RATP, SNCF, and other operators

Madrid — EMT / Metro Madrid / Adif

- **National rail (Adif/Renfe, 2019):** 37,662 items managed; **41% returned**
- Uses FindMyLost platform — but **explicitly does not cover Rodalies de Catalunya or Cercanías de Madrid**
- Same fragmentation problem as Barcelona — separate systems for rail and bus operators

Berlin — BVG

- **Volume:** ~25,000 items/year
- Processing time to municipal Fundbüro: ~5 days
- Storage limit: 6 weeks; then destroyed or auctioned (quarterly, Ulrich Beier Auction House)
- Notable limitation: Umbrellas, gloves, hats, scarves 'not maintained electronically' — in-person only

Singapore — SBS Transit (Documented Failure Case, 2011)

- Online form submit button did not work
- Phone lines disconnected after 3–4 minutes on hold
- Form only worked in Internet Explorer
- Hundreds of phones and laptops accumulated in 'awaiting donation' lists — items never reached rightful owners because the reporting layer was technically broken
- Root cause: Inadequate QA and poor system maintenance. Failure invisible to management until publicly reported (Yawning Bread, Oct 2011)

Hong Kong — MTR Corporation

- **Volume:** ~12,000 lost items/month (~144,000/year); ~8,300 reports/inquiries per month; ~400 items recovered daily
- **Ridership:** 5+ million daily passengers
- **Recovery rate:** Nearly **50%** of lost items returned to owners, often within 1–2 weeks
- **Retention:** At least 1 month (by-law); unclaimed items sold, proceeds invested in community projects
- **Common items:** Octopus cards (transit payment), handbags, umbrellas, seasonal/trend items

Digital Platform (launched 2021):

- Self-service online registration via MTR Mobile app and website
- **60% of lost property cases** now registered digitally (up from manual/phone only)
- Real-time case status tracking via case number

SF Express Delivery Service (launched July 2025) — First Locker-Based L&F; Pickup in Transit:

MTR partnered with SF Express (Hong Kong) to eliminate the requirement for in-person collection at the Lost Property Office. This is the **first known instance of a public transit operator offering self-service locker pickup for lost items**.

- **Delivery options:** Home delivery, SF Store pickup, or **SF Locker pickup (24/7 self-service)**
- **Network:** 1,000+ self-operated collection points (140+ SF Stores, 900+ SF Lockers) across Hong Kong
- **Price:** Flat HKD\$28 (~€3.30 / ~US\$3.60), pay-by-receiver arrangement
- **Weight limit:** Items up to 15 kg
- **Excluded:** Jewellery, electronics, and cash — must be collected in person for security verification
- **ID documents:** Free 'secret key' authentication service for secure delivery
- **Tracking:** Full shipment tracking via SF Express app

Why This Matters:

Hong Kong MTR did not build dedicated lost-property lockers — it repurposed an existing parcel locker network (SF Express). This avoided capital expenditure on new infrastructure while immediately providing 1,000+ pickup points with 24/7 availability. The model is replicable in any city with an established parcel locker network (e.g., InPost, Amazon Lockers, Correos CityPac in Spain). No European transit operator has adopted this approach yet.

4. Technology and Digital Solutions

Active Software Platforms

Platform	Type	Notable Clients	Key Features
NotLost (UK)	SaaS B2B	TfL (2022 — largest contract in Europe)	AI matching, operator workflow, customer portal
iLost (Netherlands)	SaaS B2B	Connexxion, GVB, HTM, Transdev NL	Online catalog, digital pickup scheduling, shipping
FindMyLost (Italy)	SaaS B2B	Adif Spain (long-distance rail only)	3-step owner recovery; not on Rodalies/Cercanías

Platform	Type	Notable Clients	Key Features
Find Inc. (Japan)	SaaS B2B	Keio + 33 companies; JR East (Apr 2026)	AI image registration (~1 min), 100+ languages, tripled return rates
Deliverback	API/B2B	Hotels, airports, transport	Automated notification, shipping integration
Boomerang (US)	B2B	State Farm Arena, Universal Studios	ML photo-matching for large venues

No vendor is currently deployed in TMB, FGC, or Rodalies (Barcelona).

Academic: LostNet (PLOS ONE, 2023)

- Architecture: MobileNetV2 + CBAM attention module + perceptual hashing
- **96.8% classification accuracy** on 10,499-image dataset across 10 categories
- **1.5 second inference on CPU**; 0.67 GFLOPs (edge-deployable)
- Outperformed 8 other transfer learning models
- Paper: arXiv:2301.02277; DOI: 10.1371/journal.pone.0310998

Why Matching Is Hard

- Item descriptions by owners are vague and subjective ('black backpack' matches thousands of items)
- Staff descriptions use different terminology to what owners would use
- No standardised taxonomy for item types and attributes across operators
- Time delay between loss and reporting — memories fade, descriptions become less accurate
- Items move through multiple custody points without persistent digital identity
- No unique identifier attached to most physical items at point of loss

5. Why Systems Fail: Documented Failure Modes

1. Chain-of-Custody Attrition (NYC MTA — IG Audit)

Items pass through: vehicle driver → station staff → depot → LP unit. At each handover, items can drop out of the tracking chain. In NYC, **80%+ of test items never reached the LP unit**. There is no evidence Barcelona has systematically audited its own chain-of-custody.

2. Description Matching at Scale (TfL Legacy / Most Operators)

Text descriptions entered by staff are vague. No standardised taxonomy. Staff and owners use different terminology. No image capture at point of registration. Matching is a needle-in-haystack problem that degrades catastrophically with volume.

3. Broken Digital Interface (SBS Transit Singapore, 2011)

Submit button didn't work. Phone lines disconnected. Browser-restricted to Internet Explorer. Items accumulated in a 'digital' system that was functionally inaccessible. Failure invisible to management until publicly reported.

4. Multi-Operator Coordination Vacuum (Barcelona, Madrid, UK Rail)

No shared database across operators. Passengers don't know which operator's vehicle they were on. Transport Focus (UK) found **23 separate UK train companies with incompatible systems**; passengers 'unable, despite repeated attempts, to contact the company.' Their recommendation: a centralised national database. Barcelona has four operators and no coordination layer.

5. Timing and Access Barriers (Universal)

- Items take 4+ days to process (TMB bus: weekend depot closures)
- Physical collection required — impossible for tourists who've left the city
- Oficina de Troballes hours: Mon–Fri 9am–2pm only
- TMB online form frequently non-functional
- 10-day holding window at Diagonal before transfer to Vilapicina depot

6. Pessimism and Awareness (Behavioural — NotLost Research)

Many people assume lost items will not be returned and don't attempt recovery. Those who do attempt face a discouraging process with no feedback loop (no tracking, no notifications). Self-fulfilling: low expectations → low attempt rate → low return rate statistics → reinforced low expectations.

7. Generic Lost-and-Found Apps (Consumer Market)

Several consumer-facing 'report your lost item' apps have failed to gain traction because they require both the finder and the loser to use the same app — a coordination problem with no incentive mechanism. Without institutional adoption, the network effect never materialises.

6. What Works: Success Factors from Best-in-Class Systems

Factor	Seoul	Tokyo (Find Inc.)	Hong Kong (MTR)	Paris (FranceObjets)	Barcelona	NYC
National/city unified DB	✓ LOST112	Partial	✓ (single operator)	✓ national	✗	✗
AI/image-based registration	✗	✓ (1 min/item)	✗	✗	✗	✗
Real-time status tracking	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	Partial
Delivery/shipping service	✗	✗	✓ SF Express	✗	✗	✗
Self-service locker pickup	✗	✗	✓ 1,000+ points	✗	✗	✗
Multi-operator unified interface	✓	Partial	N/A (single op.)	✓	✗	✗

Factor	Seoul	Tokyo (Find Inc.)	Hong Kong (MTR)	Paris (FranceObjets)	Barcelona	NYC
Tourist/multilingual support	Limited	✓ (100+ lang.)	✓ (En/Zh)	Limited	✗	Limited
Chain-of-custody audit	Unknown	✓	Unknown	Unknown	✗	✗ (failed)

Seoul's Key Insight

LOST112 is a single national source-of-truth. Any item registered by any station employee is immediately visible to all police and all citizens. The integration layer is what drives 85% recovery — not technology sophistication, but data unification.

Tokyo (Find Inc.) Key Insight

AI registration at first point of custody reduces staff time per item by 10x and standardises data quality, enabling AI matching downstream. Return rate tripled (→30%) at Keio after 6 months. The bottleneck moved from 'item not registered well enough to be found' to 'items actually matched and returned.'

Paris Key Insight

84% of items are found by other passengers, not staff. The bottleneck is not willingness to return but the friction of the reporting and matching system. Infrastructure that empowers civilian finders would capture a large share of the item flow.

Hong Kong (MTR + SF Express) Key Insight

The only transit operator globally to offer self-service locker pickup for lost property. Instead of building dedicated infrastructure, MTR repurposed SF Express's existing 1,000+ locker/store network — achieving 24/7 city-wide collection point coverage at zero capital cost. Combined with a digital platform (60% of cases registered online) and ~50% recovery rate, Hong Kong demonstrates that the 'last mile' of lost-property return can be solved with logistics partnerships rather than custom hardware. The HKD\$28 flat fee is low enough to remove cost as a barrier while covering courier logistics.

7. Academic and Policy Research

"Civic Honesty Around the Globe"

Cohn, Maréchal, Tannenbaum, Zünd — Science (June 2019)

17,303 'lost wallets' dropped in 355 cities across 40 countries. Return rates ranged **14%–76% by country**. Counter-intuitively, people were more likely to return wallets containing more money — contradicting economic self-interest. Attributed to altruism and aversion to self-image as a thief. Cultural and institutional factors create enormous variance globally.

- DOI: 10.1126/science.aau8712

"Investigating the Moral Behaviour of Public Transport Users in Returning Lost Items"

Urban, Planning and Transport Research, Vol. 12, No. 1 (2024)

n=603 respondents; Cronbach's α =0.804. Religious values (M=4.41, SD=1.97) and empathy (M=4.37, SD=1.92) were the two most significant factors in deciding to return lost items. Monetary value of an item was not a consistent factor. Finder willingness is primarily moral/cultural — consistent with Japan/Seoul findings.

- DOI: 10.1080/21650020.2024.2305277

"LostNet: A Smart Way for Lost and Found"

PLOS ONE (2023) — arXiv:2301.02277

System: MobileNetV2 + CBAM + perceptual hashing. **96.8% accuracy** on 10,499-image dataset across 10 categories. **1.5s inference on CPU**; 0.67 GFLOPs. Outperformed 8 transfer learning models. Edge-deployable on low-power hardware.

- DOI: 10.1371/journal.pone.0310998

"Back on Track: Lost and Found on Public Transportation"

Springer Nature (2013)

80% of instances of lost property arise from 20% of error types — Pareto principle applied to transit losses. Frames the problem as an error-management challenge.

Transport Focus: Lost Property Briefing (UK Consumer Watchdog)

23 separate UK train companies use incompatible systems. Passengers 'unable, despite repeated attempts by telephone and email, to make contact with the company.' Items disappear after being handed to operators. Recommendation: **centralised national database and standardised rules**. Some operators improving individually but systemic fragmentation persists.

- Source: transportfocus.org.uk/publication/lost-property-a-briefing/

8. Key Statistics Summary

City / System	Items/Year	Recovery Rate	Tech Status
Barcelona TMB	22,000–27,000	~25–30%	Phone + broken web form; no app
Barcelona Oficina de Troballes	20,000–32,200	~35%	In-person; ISO 9001 certified
London TfL	200,000–438,000	21.7%	NotLost AI platform (since 2022)
NYC MTA	~68,000	~17% reach LP unit (IG audit)	Manual; audited systemic failure
Tokyo	4.4 million	~14% overall; phones 83%	Find Inc. AI (33 companies, 2025)

City / System	Items/Year	Recovery Rate	Tech Status
Seoul	152,540	Up to 85%	LOST112 national integrated DB
Hong Kong MTR	~144,000	~50%	Online platform + SF Express locker/delivery (2025)
Paris RATP	~200,000	~25% est.	FranceObjetsTraouvés national platform
Berlin BVG	~25,000	N/A	Online DB; some items in-person only

Core tension: Finder willingness is not the bottleneck (90% of finders try to return items; 84% in Paris are passengers who actively want to help). The bottleneck is **matching infrastructure, chain-of-custody integrity, and passenger-facing accessibility**. Barcelona sits at the low end of the global distribution on all three dimensions.

9. Source Index

Source	URL / Reference
TMB official lost property	tmb.cat/en/customer-services/procedures/lost-property
TMB statistics (Catalan)	noticies.tmb.cat/transport/com-funciona-recollida-dobjectes-perduts-metro-autobusos
Barcelona lost & found guide	salirporbarcelona.com/en/lost-and-found-objects-in-barcelonas-public-transportation-system
Oficina de Troballes process	barcelonayellow.com/bcn/lost-property-barcelona/lost-property-barcelona-bus-metro-tram-tmb
3Cat article (35% return rate)	3cat.cat/3catinfo/uns-ho-perden-daltres-ho-troben-com-funciona-loficina-de-troballes
ATM 2023 record journeys (1,087M)	ce.atm.cat — press release Feb 2024
TMB transport figures	tmb.cat/en/about-tmb/get-to-know-us/transport-figures
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Tokyo Metropolitan lost-found	english.metro.tokyo.lg.jp/w/000-101-006544
Seoul 2024 subway stats	hapskorea.com/seoul-subway-lost-found-trends-150000-items-left-behind-in-2024/
LOST112 national system (Korea)	lost112.go.kr/manyLanguage.do?langType=en

Source	URL / Reference
RATP lost and found	ratp.fr/en/services-aux-voyageurs/services-aux-voyageurs/station-services/lost-found-how-does-it-work
Hong Kong MTR delivery service press release (Jul 2025)	mtr.com.hk/archive/corporate/en/press_release/PR-25-052-E.pdf
Hong Kong MTR lost property page	mtr.com.hk/en/customer/services/lost.html
MTR 12,000 items/month (Dimsum Daily)	dimsumdaily.hk/mtr-handles-12000-lost-items-monthly-ranging-from-octopus-card-to-pickled-vegetables/
SFHK + MTR partnership details	htm.sf-express.com/hk/en/information/detail/SFHK-Launches-Lost-Property-Delivery-Service-with-MTR-...
MTR + SF Express (The Standard HK)	thestandard.com.hk/hong-kong-news/article/307162/MTR-joins-hands-with-SF-Express-to-launch-lost-property-delivery-service
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